

Domain Authoring Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe **operations that change, reveal, or communicate business state**.

This guide is about **commands, events, queries, documents, errors, and key domain questions**.

What belongs here

- business operations
- events that matter to the domain
- questions the domain must answer
- important errors or failure conditions
- causal links between operations

What does not belong here

- the full narrative sequence of a journey
- the UI flow of screens and actions
- broad business goals or risks without operational relevance

Core things to capture

- what operation happens
- whether it is a request, fact, read, or document exchange
- what it changes or reveals
- what can happen next
- what can go wrong
- what important question it answers

Core relationships to capture

- command -> event/result
- query -> information returned

- operation -> concept affected
- operation -> rule/risk/quality concern
- question -> operation that answers it

Modus operandi

Describe the domain as meaningful acts:

1. name the important business operations
2. separate requests from facts and reads
3. describe what each operation causes or answers
4. capture important failures and gaps
5. connect operations to concepts and rules

Prompt set

- what business action is being requested?
- what fact happens afterward?
- what questions must the system answer?
- what concepts are changed or read?
- what are the important failure modes?

Free-text intake template

- **Operation or question name:**
- **Kind (request/fact/read/document/question):**
- **Purpose:**
- **What it affects or returns:**
- **What may happen next:**
- **Related concepts/rules:**
- **Important errors or gaps:**

Worked example

- Submit Leave Request is a request to create a leave request
- Leave Request Submitted is the fact that follows successful submission
- Get Leave Balance answers how much leave is still available
- Overlapping Leave Error appears when dates conflict with policy or approved leave

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into domain operations, questions, and errors, linking them to concepts, stories, and rules.

Common mistakes

- mixing user-interface actions with domain operations
- describing only labels and not effects
- forgetting the difference between a request and a fact
- omitting important errors or unanswered questions